supporters and opponents will continue to argue on these matters, the fact is that, between 2014 and 2020, the BJP has won more elections in India than it has lost. It is important to understand why.

This is especially so in an era where, as one articulate MLA told the psephologist and journalist Prannoy Roy, 'Elections have become like exams. There are a number of papers that have to be passed. You don't have to do brilliantly in each paper; but in order to be elected, your average marks should be *at least* distinction. Voters today will not accept only pass marks … to merely pass today means that you have failed, you'll be voted out.' Election data, as Roy (not known to be close to the BJP) has shown, consistently point to the fact that since 2002, India has been in a 'wiser voter' phase, where voters have rewarded performing governments far more than in the past.[16] The BJP has been winning more exams, to take this analogy forward, than any other political party. By emerging as the dominant player in what was a fragmented party system since the early 1990s, it has led the game-changing shift in Indian politics, the biggest in three decades. It is winning elections because enough people in India, outside of its traditional vote banks, agree with its politics. This book explains how.

Why Modi Is the New Nehru for the Indian Cultural Right

Such a comparative study is important because Modi's political ascendance, and what it means for India, is as impactful and far-reaching as the political imprint left by the country's first prime minister, Jawaharlal Nehru. Modi may be the mirror opposite of most things Nehru stood for, but in terms of impact, the tectonic shifts he has heralded in Indian politics are Nehruvian in scale. So deep and wide-ranging is the societal impact of Moditva that, of all Indian prime ministers, he can be compared with only Nehru.

This may seem like a strange comparison to make. Nehru, after all, is the most reviled name in the Indian Right's political lexicon. He is often lampooned as soft, wimpish and placatory, as opposed to Modi, who embodies, for his political supporters, strength, manliness and resoluteness.